

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 9 8 5

♥ K 7

♦ 9 7 4 3

♣ 8 7 2

♠ A 10 2

♥ A 8 2

♦ A Q 10 2

♣ Q 6 3



♠ Q 6 4

♥ Q J 10 5 3

♦ 8 5

♣ A 10 4

♠ K 7 3

♥ 9 6 4

♦ K J 6

♣ K J 9 5

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♥Q

drive out the ♣A while he still has ♥s stopped.

It was a good thing you held the ♥K rather than declarer, but it is a nuisance that you must get out of the way on the very first trick.

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥Q, dummy played the ♥4

Play the ♥K.

Admittedly you have a terrible hand. But that's no reason to be careless. **YOU** can beat this contract, but you have to do it right now by unblocking the ♥K. If declarer holds up you will continue with your ♥7 and partner will establish his suit while he still has the ♣A for an entry. If declarer doesn't hold up it will be just as bad for him.

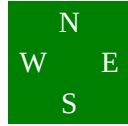
But suppose you say "Well, partner's ♥Q is just as good as my ♥K so I'll just save the King for later" as you play low. Declarer will love you. He will hold up on the ♥Q, then again on trick two when you play the ♥K. AND HE WILL STILL HAVE HIS ♥A when you switch to another suit. He will have time to

Board 2

North Deals
None Vul

♠ 9 8 3
♥ J 9 6 2
♦ A 7 3
♣ Q 10 8

♠ A Q J 10 7
♥ A 5
♦ K 4 2
♣ A J 2



♠ K 6 2
♥ K Q 3
♦ 10 9 8 5
♣ 9 7 3

♠ 5 4
♥ 10 8 7 4
♦ Q J 6
♣ K 6 5 4

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	1NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♥ 2			

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥ 2, dummy played the ♥ A

Play the ♥ Q (or ♥ K).

You know partner has a 4-card ♥ suit, (he led the deuce), and you know it is headed by an honor. You hope the honor is the ♥ J, but in any case you must get your high ♥ s out of the way.

Declarer will probably come to his hand and then take a ♠ finesse. You win the ♠ K, take your other high ♥ , then lead your ♥ 3 toward your partner.

As you see, partner did hold the ♥ J 9, so your side wins 3 ♥ tricks.

If declarer played low on the first trick you would win the ♥ Q, then play the ♥ K to dummy's ♥ A.

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A J 7
 ♥ 6 4 2
 ♦ 10 9 8 5
 ♣ 9 7 3

♠ Q 4 3

♥ J 7

♦ K J 4 3

♣ K Q J 5



♠ 10 8 6 5

♥ A K 3

♦ Q 7 2

♣ 8 4 2

♠ K 9 2

♥ Q 10 9 8 5

♦ A 6

♣ A 10 6

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1 ♥
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by North			
Lead: ♠ 5			

able to cash his last ♠.

Note that if dummy's ♠ 9 was played you would cover with your ♠ J, leading to the same situation.

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠ 5, dummy played the ♠ 2

Play the ♠ 7.

Partner's low ♠ lead tells you he has an honor in the suit, so it must be either the ♠ Q or the ♠ 10. North's jump to 2NT makes it almost certain that he holds the ♠ Q, so you can figure partner probably led from ♠ 10 x x 5.

Apply the Rule of 11. 11 minus 5 = 6 cards higher than the ♠ 5 held by dummy, you, and declarer. Since you can see 5 of the 6 you conclude that that declarer will have to play his ♠ Q to beat your ♠ 7.

North will take the ♠ Q at trick 1, but when East wins a high ♥ he will play another ♠ through dummy's ♠ K 9 to your ♠ A J. Once you clear dummy's ♠ away partner will win another ♥ and be

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 8 5 2
 ♥ J 10 6 5 2
 ♦ 6 4
 ♣ 9 3

♠ J 6 4

♥ 9 8

♦ A 5

♣ A J 10 7 4 2



♠ 9 7 3

♥ A Q 7

♦ J 10 8 7 3

♣ K 6

♠ A Q 10

♥ K 4 3

♦ K Q 9 2

♣ Q 8 5

West	North	East	South
			1NT

Pass 3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♥5

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥5, dummy played the ♥8

Play the ♥Q.

The Rule of Eleven tells you there are 6 cards in North, East and South that are higher than the ♥5. You can see 5 of them, so that leaves just one of them for South.

West cannot have all three of the outstanding honors, because from ♥K J 10 x x his correct lead would be the Jack. So you can deduce that South must hold exactly one of ♥K, ♥J, or ♥10.

If his honor is not the ♥K then it won't matter whether you play ♥A or ♥Q to the first trick; you will win your two top cards and then play your small one back to West.

So assume South actually holds the ♥K x x. If you play the ♥A to trick one, then lead ♥Q, South will hold up on the second trick, and win the third ♥. Then, when you win your ♣K you will not have a ♥ to return to partner and declarer will make the contract.

So what happens if you play the ♥Q at trick one? South could still make the contract by holding up, **but he will be afraid to do so**. After all, from his perspective it looks like West probably holds the ♥A and he will be afraid of losing the first 5 ♥ tricks, perhaps even when the ♣K finessing is working!

Board 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 7 4
♥ A K 4
♦ 10 9 8 4
♣ 10 8 4 2

♠ Q 10 9 6 2
♥ 8 5 3
♦ K J 3
♣ J 6



♠ K 5
♥ Q J 9 7 2
♦ A Q 6
♣ 9 7 3

♠ A J 8 3
♥ 10 6
♦ 7 5 2
♣ A K Q 5

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1 ♣
Pass	1 ♠	2 ♥	3 ♠
All Pass			
3 ♠ by North			
Lead: ♥ Q			

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥ Q, dummy played the ♥ 6

Overtake with the ♥ K.

Your side needs to take 5 tricks to defeat this contract. Two of them will be ♥ s, but it doesn't look like you can win any ♣ s or ♠ s.

That means you need to win 3 ♦ tricks and the only way that can happen is if you play ♦ s from your side.

So win the first ♥ K (so partner will know you also have the ♥ A), and play the ♦ 10. Presumably North will play an honor, but East will take the trick and put you back on lead with your ♥ A. You play the ♦ 9 and your side will collect 3 ♦ tricks to go with your 2 ♥ s.

Board 6

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A K Q 8 6 4

♥ 8

♦ 7 4 2

♣ A J 9

♠ J 3

♥ K Q J 6

♦ A K Q 10 5

♣ 6 2



♠ 10

♥ 7 3 2

♦ 9 8 6 3

♣ Q 7 5 4 3

♠ 9 7 5 2

♥ A 10 9 5 4

♦ J

♣ K 10 8

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

1 ♦

Pass

1 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by South

Lead: ♠ A

through South's ♣ K at trick 3.

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠ A, then the ♠ K. Dummy follows suit and it is your play to the second trick.

Ruff partner's ♠ K.

It is obvious that your side can only get 2 ♠ tricks. And assuming that South has the Ace of trumps you will not make a single trick in the red suits. So you need to make 2 ♣ tricks.

If partner has the ♣ A K then he will take them, but if he has the ♣ A J he cannot win 2 ♣ tricks from his side.

To allow for this situation it will be better to play ♣s from your side of the table, and the way to make that happen is for you to ruff partner's ♠ K with an otherwise useless trump. You still get your two ♠ winners (sort of) but now you get to play a ♣